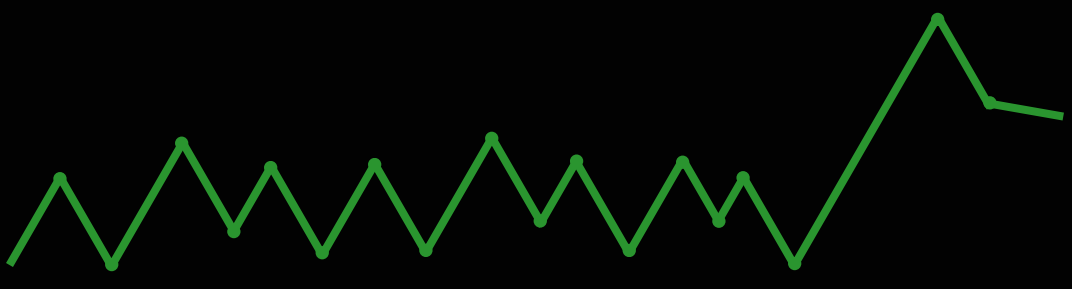
THE ONLY TIMES

YOU SHOULD EVER DAY TRADE



TIME IS DIFFERENCE BETWEEN
PROFIT AND CHOP



By Sam Sidney

The Best Times of Day to Trade

By Sam Sidney

Introduction:

Can you place a trade at anytime during market hours? 100%.

But the truth is not all hours are created equal. Some hours are full of momentum, liquidity, and clean price action that make sense. Other hours are slow, choppy, and full of traps that will stop you out.

If you want to stack the odds in your favour, you need to know when the market is most active.

Most beginners ignore timing because they're chasing the quick dopamine hit of placing a trade. But the truth is, time is a hidden edge, and often the difference between catching clean setups or getting stuck in a frustrating trade for hours.

1. Why Time Matters

Every trade you take is influenced by when you take it.

During quiet hours, price often drifts sideways. It can move a few points up and down in a tight consolidation, without conviction, and those little fake moves are exactly what shake traders out of a good set up.

You could have the best read on the market, the best entry, but if you place a trade at the wrong time, the probability of the trade playing out cleanly decreases dramatically.

- The market runs on liquidity, the money traders put in. But it never flows evenly. At some prices there is too much buying, at others too much selling, and that imbalance is what drives price to move.

- The strongest liquidity comes when the world's biggest financial markets open and overlap. That's when institutions are most active, and when price finally makes real moves.

Once you understand that time is tied to liquidity, you'll stop wasting energy in the dead zones and start focusing on optimal trading windows that matter.

2. Kill Zones

“Kill zones” are periods of time when the market is most likely to make meaningful moves. Instead of staring at charts for hours, traders can zoom in on these short windows and catch the most impactful price action.

Asia Kill Zone (8 PM – 10 PM EST):

Best for AUD, NZD, and JPY pairs. Price often moves sideways, forming the overnight range. Markets often consolidate during this session because lower volatility and fewer participants.

Liquidity then accumulates around key highs and lows, these levels then become targets for the next session. Avoid trading Asia

London Kill Zone (2 AM – 5 AM EST):

The most active forex session. Big moves on EUR and GBP. Moves are often more expansive than Asia, especially during London open. High liquidity + active participation from banks, institutions, and hedge funds drives slightly bigger moves.

Price will either take Asia liquidity and reverse or displace the Asia range to target the next level of time based liquidity. (Great for beginners)

New York Kill Zone (7 AM – 9 AM EST):

Best for US based pairs and assets. NY will be the most expansive session of the day as US banks and institutions enter the market.

Liquidity from London and Asia is often taken and expanded during the NY open, creating strong directional moves.

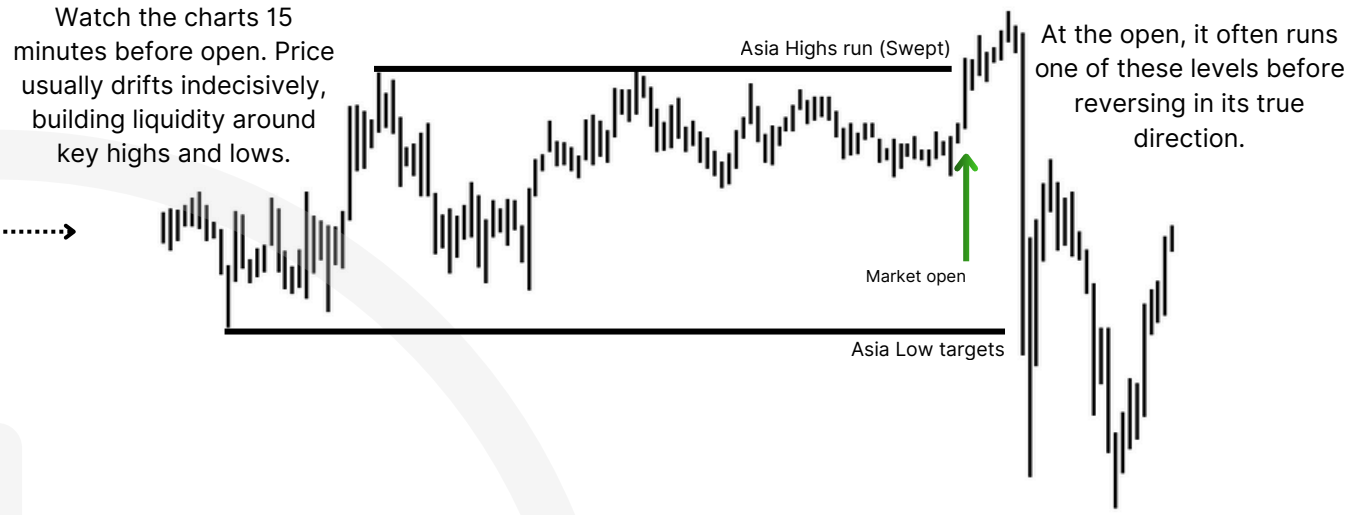
Economic news releases from the US can also accelerate trends or cause sharp swings. Watch for previous daily highs and lows being taken out. Ideal for intermediate traders, who are comfortable with more volatility.

3.Session Opens

When a session opens for the day, new liquidity floods in. Orders from banks, hedge funds, retail and institutions hit the market, often creating sharp moves in a either direction before the real trade set up is formed.

London Session Open: 2:00 AM EST
New York AM Open: 9:30 AM EST
New York PM Open: 13:30 PM EST
Asia Session Open: 20:00 PM EST
True Day Open: 0:00 EST

Session opens are where the market moves fast, and can be deceptive. Price often grabs liquidity with a quick fake-out before showing its real direction. Chasing the first spike is risky; it can easily stop you out or leave you trapped. The patient trader waits, observes if the move holds or reverses, and only takes trades when the edge is clear.



It's important to wait for confirmation of an entry model before entering at open as price can be very choppy as new orders enter the market. The Playbit ILM strategy is perfect for this.

We trade futures live inside Playbit every single day at 9:15 EST for the New York open and **free to the public on Tuesdays and Sundays...**

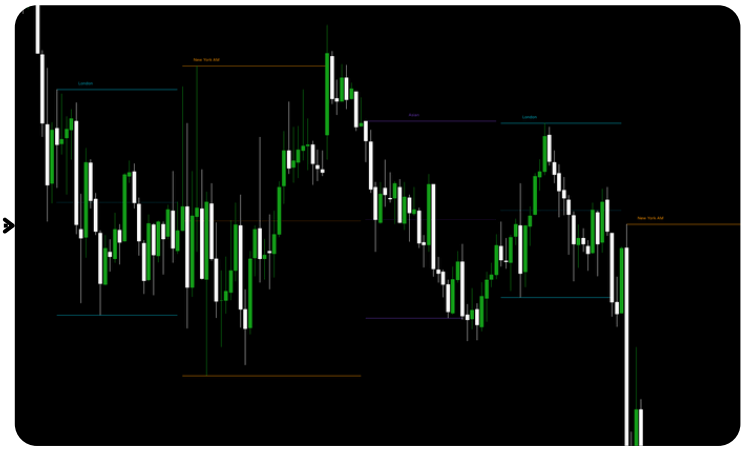
Tap here to trade alongside the team every Tuesday for a better understanding.

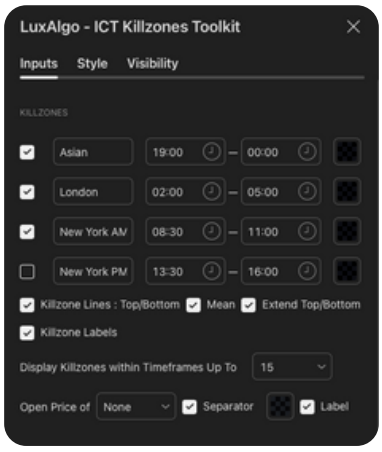
4. Indicators

Indicators will help you track each session time more accurately to ensure you have the right levels of liquidity as well as save you time not having to set them up manually with trend lines.

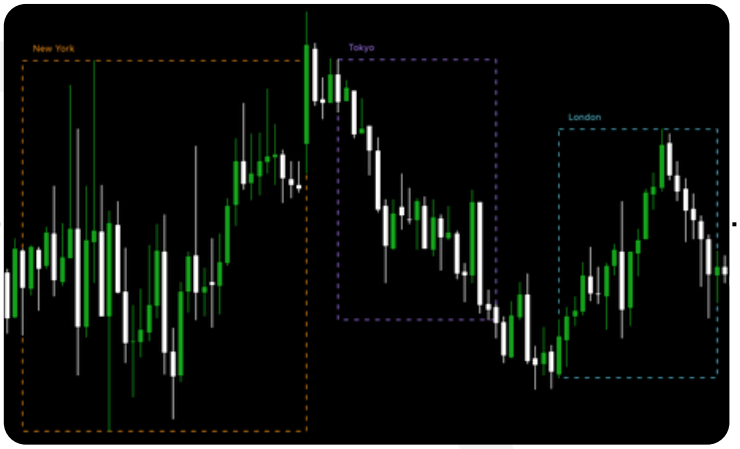
My favourite tools and the ones the **Playbit Community** use are:

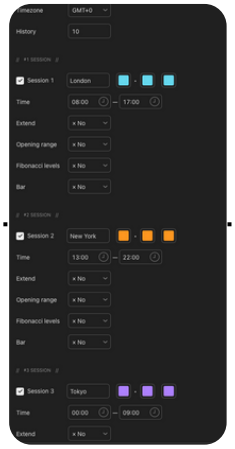
ICT Kill Zones Toolkit (LuxAlgo)





FX Market Sessions (Boitoki)

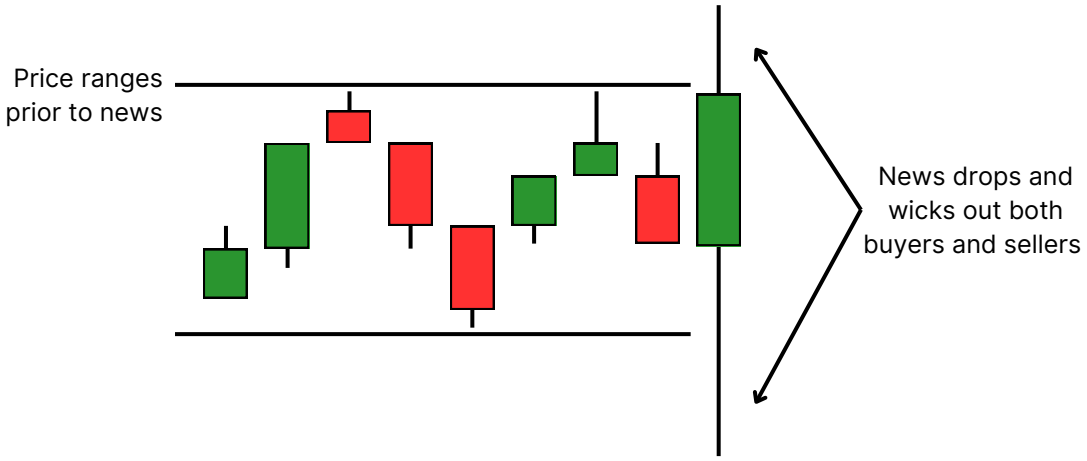




Having these indicators makes it easier to anticipate reversals and periods when the market is more likely to move. mark the highs and lows of each session and then hide the indicator. Less clutter = more clarity.

5. News

High-impact news events can cause massive price swings and wicks in the market, within seconds of the news dropping.



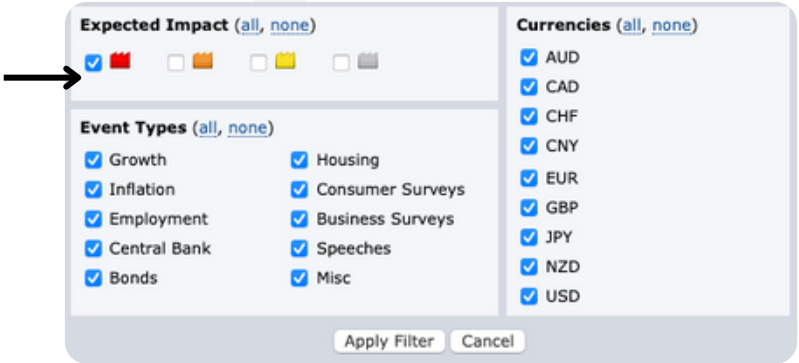
The most important news days include:

- FOMC (Federal Reserve interest rate decisions)
- NFP (Non-Farm Payrolls, first Friday of each month)
- CPI (Consumer Price Index, inflation data)

News creates huge wicks and violent swings as the market digests new information. Yes, you can make money trading news, but it's a double-edged sword, many traders blow up accounts trying to catch the chaos, Inside Playbit we have a strategy specifically designed to profit from these high impact news releases, the data has shown our strategy to have a 90% win rate making it a great way to stack funded accounts quickly.

The smarter move? Let the news hit, let the dust settle, and then look for the true direction once price stabilizes. That's often when the cleanest trades appear.

To identify when the most impactful news days are, use the filter setting on forexfacotry.com then single out red folder days. You should always be considering these events prior to trading.



6. Homework

Each session sets its own high & low. These levels often act as magnets for price.

For example:

- Price may revisit the London high during the New York session.
- A session low can act as a support where buyers step in.
- These levels tie directly into liquidity concepts, where price hunts stops before continuing.

Challenge: Apply a session indicator to your chart. For the last 30 days, mark each session's highs and lows. Watch how often the next session reacts to the prior sessions levels.

Getting into the habit of doing this every day pre market can sharpen your eye for liquidity and opportunities to enter the market, which is liquidity 101.

Quick Recap

Before taking a trade, ask yourself:

- Am I trading during a kill zone?
- Which session is active right now?
- Are we near a high-impact news event?
- Where are the previous sessions highs and lows?

If you can answer those questions with clarity and confidence, you're already ahead of most traders who jump in just for the dopamine hit.

By mastering the context of time, you start building the foundations of a system that actually works, one that frees you from being glued to the charts all day and chasing trades that aren't there.

Now that you know when to trade, the next question is: how do I read the market?

That's exactly what I'll be addressing in the guides to follow.

You've now got the blueprint for the best times to trade.

But don't just read this and move on. The real progress comes when you apply it.

Head over to TradingView, mark up your charts with the key sessions, and start tracking how price behaves during those windows. Repetition builds mastery.

If you enjoyed this guide, use the links below to follow me across my socials so you don't miss the next one. And if you know a trader who could use this, share it with them, the goal is to spread the word.

Keep sharpening your edge. Timing is everything.

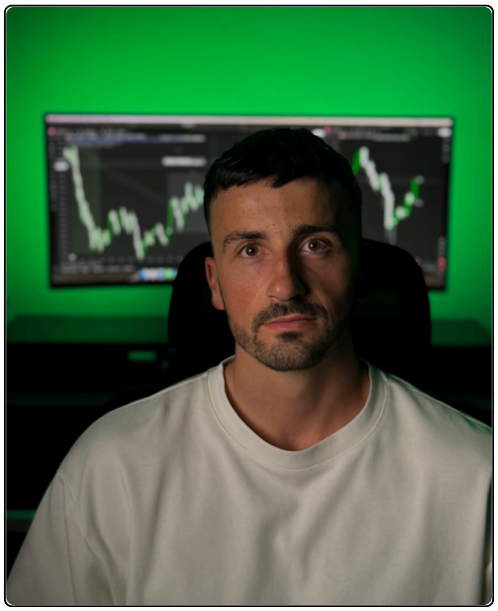
See you inside,

– Sam Sidney

PS. if you want to take it further, tap here to join us live every Tuesday 9:15 EST inside Playbit for the NY Open.

You'll see how professional traders use timing, structure, and liquidity to frame real trades in the markets live in front of your eyes.

Keep sharpening your edge, and never give up on trading.



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